Understanding the Human Being: The Co-existence of Self and Body

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Introduction

- A human being is a combination of two important aspects:
  - ✓ The **Self** (Consciousness): The part that thinks, feels, and makes decisions.
  - ✓ The **Body** (Material): The physical entity that performs actions.



Image Source: https://www.sandstonecare.com/

Understanding the Needs of the Self & the Body

- Needs of the Body (Physical Needs): Food, water, sleep, and shelter—essential for survival.
- Needs of the Self (Emotional & Psychological Needs): Happiness, love, respect, and trust—essential for well-being.



Image Source: https://www.theschoolrun.com/

Understanding the Needs of the Self & the Body

- **Key Idea:** Physical needs can be met with material resources, but emotional needs require relationships and understanding.

Human Being	Self ⟷ Co-existence ⟷ Body	
Need	Happiness	Physical Facility
In Time	Continues (e.g. Respect)	Temporary (e.g. Food)
In Quantity	Qualitative (is Feeling)	Quantitative (Required in Limited Quantity)

Fulfillment of Needs for a Balanced Life

- The Body's needs are fulfilled through physical actions (e.g., eating when hungry).
- The Self's needs are fulfilled through relationships, understanding, and self-awareness.
- Physical comfort does not guarantee happiness; both aspects must be balanced.

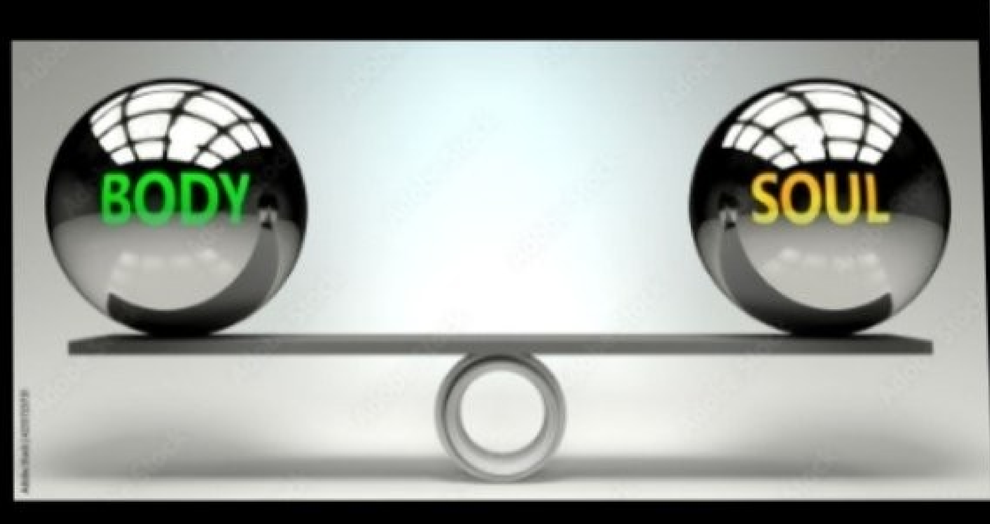
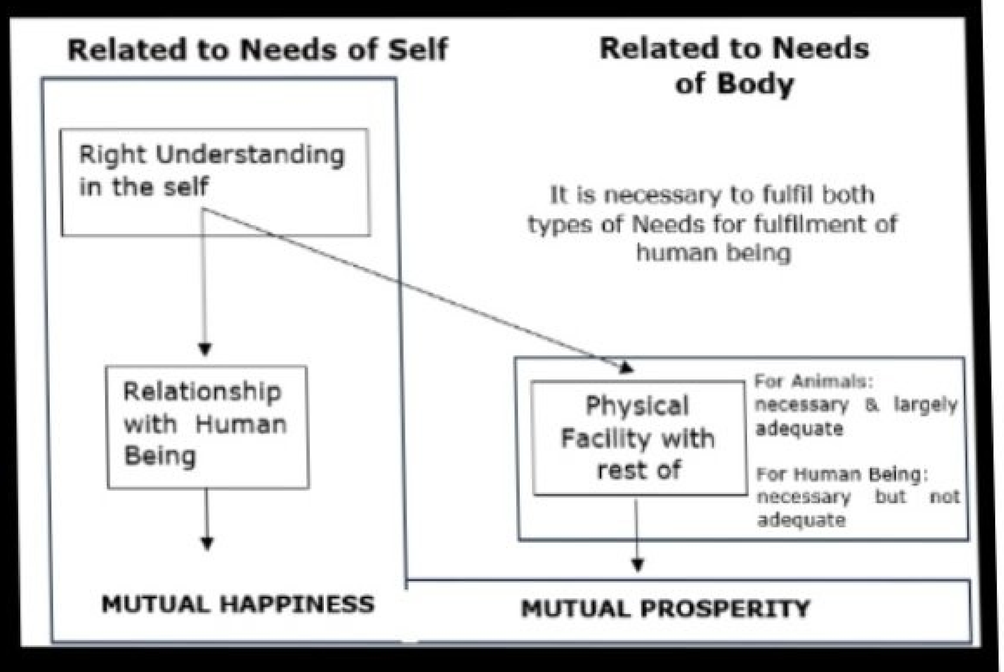


Image Source: https://stock.adobe.com/

Definiteness of the Needs of the Self vs. Variability of the Body's Needs

- **Body's Needs Change:** Depend on age, health, climate, etc. (e.g., a child eats less than an adult).
- **Self's Needs are Definite:** Love, respect, and happiness are universally needed at all stages of life.
- **Key Idea:** While physical needs change, emotional well-being remains constant.



Activities of the Self and the Body

- **The Self's Activities:**
  - ✓Continuous processes like desires, thoughts, and expectations (never stop).
- **The Body's Activities:**
  - ✓Temporary processes like eating, walking, sleeping (require rest).
- **The Self's activities are ongoing, while the Body needs rest and recovery.**

Human Being	Self	Body
Activity	Desire, Thoughts, Expectations…	Eating, walking.
In Time	Continues	Temporary

Responses of the Self and Body

- The Body responds to physical conditions:
  (e.g., a sharp needle pierces the skin).
- The Self responds based on assumptions:
  (e.g., the reaction to a needle depends on who is holding it).
- **Example:** A doctor using a needle vs. an attacker using a needle—same physical action, different emotional response.





Image Source: https://www.vecteezy.com/

Role of Assumptions in Human Behavior

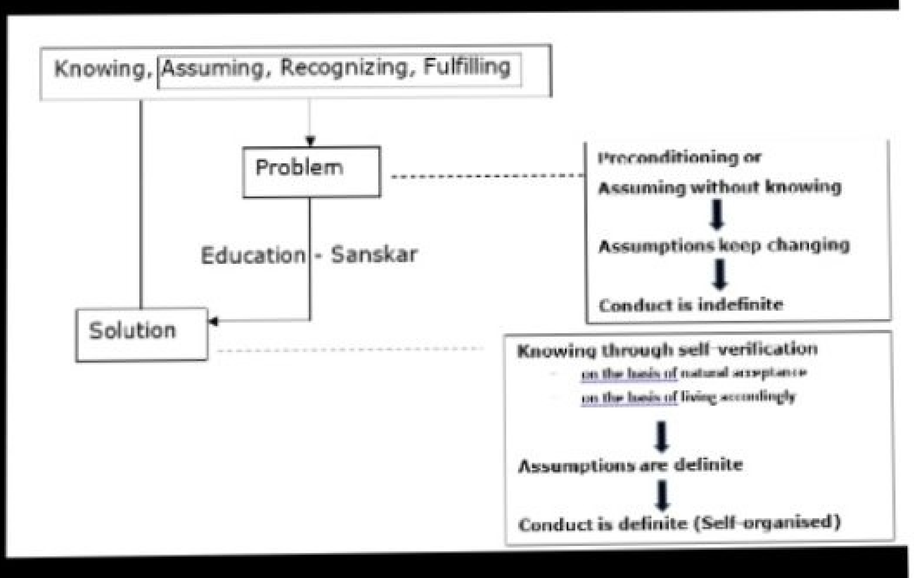
- Assumptions are shaped by:
  - ✓Society & upbringing (preconditioning)
  - ✓Experiences through senses (sensation)
  - ✓Inner understanding (natural acceptance)
- Impact: Incorrect assumptions lead to stress, while right understanding leads to clarity and happiness.

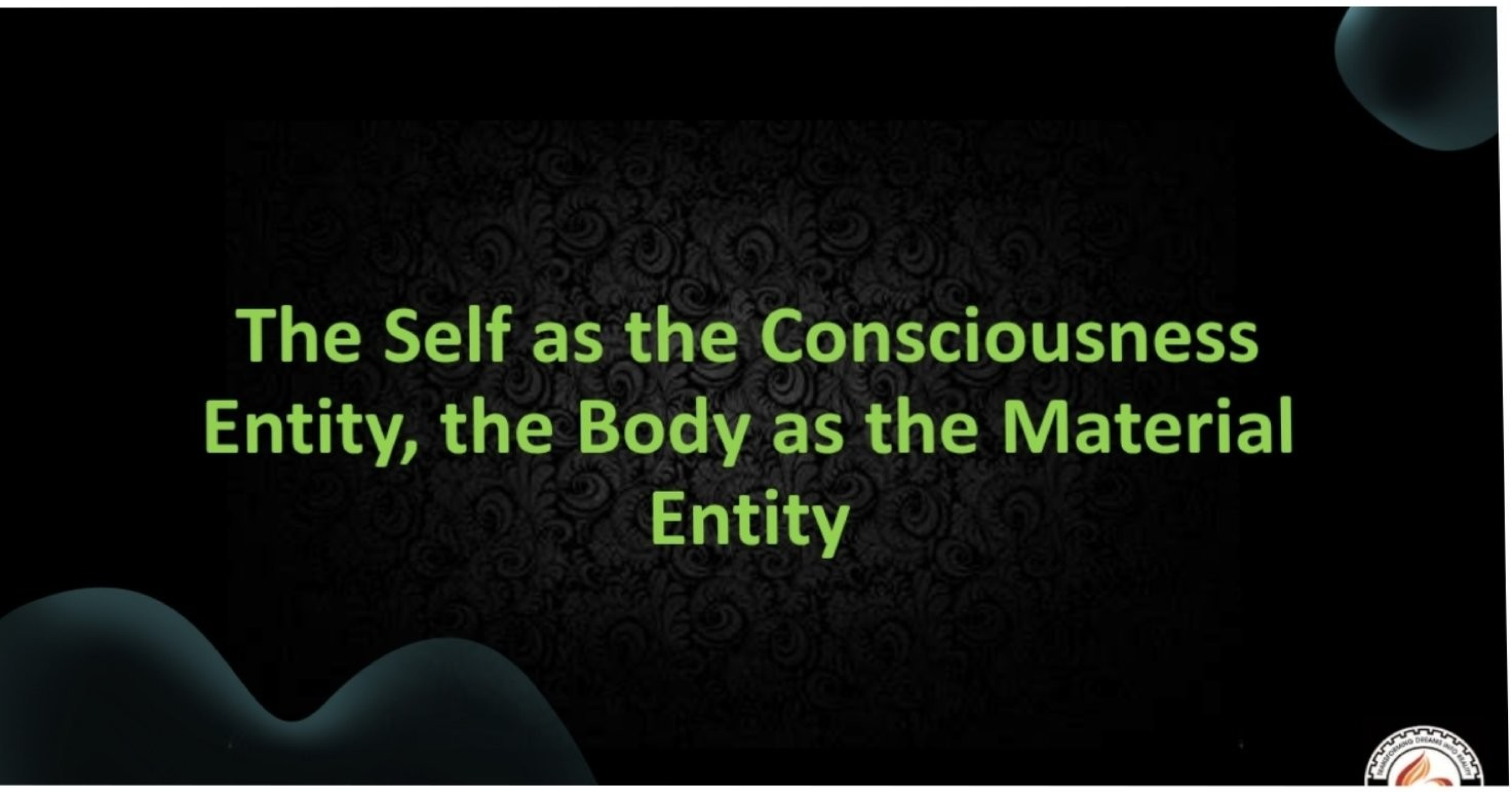


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Right Understanding Leads to Better Responses

- **Moving from Assumptions to Knowing:**
  - ✓ **Education and self-awareness help correct false beliefs.**
  - ✓ **When we operate on knowing rather than assumption, our behavior becomes stable, harmonious, and positive.**
- **Example: If we assume people are unfriendly, we stay distant. If we understand they are kind, we build relationships.**




The Self as the Consciousness Entity, the Body as the Material Entity

Human Being as Co-existence of Self and Body

- The Self (Consciousness): Thinks, feels, decides; experiences emotions like happiness, love, and trust.
- The Body (Material): Performs physical actions like moving, eating, sleeping.
- Key Insight: The Self and the Body are interdependent but distinct.



Image Source: https://www.zevohealth.com/

The Self as the Consciousness Entity

- Exists in the domain of consciousness.
- Responsible for knowing, assuming, recognizing, and fulfilling.
- Needs: Happiness, respect, love, and trust.
- Example: A person with wealth but lacking love and trust feels unhappy.



Image Source: https://www.livescience.com/

The Body as the Material Entity

- Exists in the domain of matter.
- Needs: Food, water, sleep, shelter.
- Functions through recognition and fulfillment of physical needs.
- Example: A well-fed but emotionally neglected person may feel empty.



Image Source: https://www.pngtree.com/

Gross Misunderstanding – Assuming Human Being to be Only the Body

- People try to fulfill Self's needs through physical means.
- Leads to accumulation without satisfaction.
- Consequences:
  - ✓Endless accumulation of wealth.
  - ✓Lack of sense of prosperity.
  - ✓Exploitation of natural resources.
  - ✓Unhealthy competition and stress.



Image Source: https://www.freepik.com/

The Self as the Central Aspect of Human Life

- The Self is the Knower (Seer): Seeks knowledge and meaning.
- The Self is the Doer (Decision-Maker): Makes decisions, interprets body sensations.
- The Self is the Experiencer (Enjoyer): Experiences emotions, pain, joy.

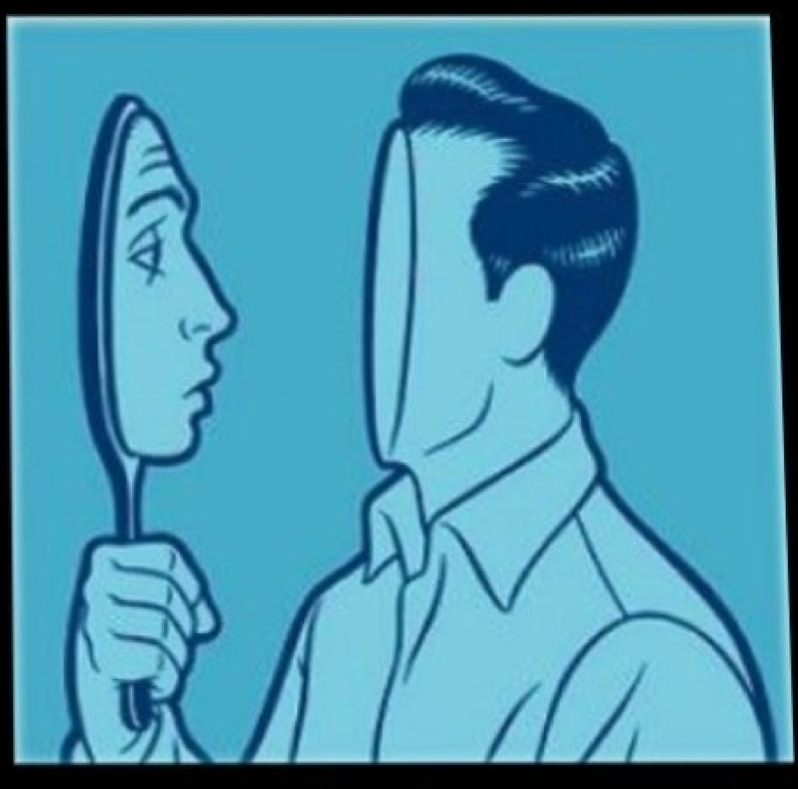


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The Role of the Self in Achieving Balance

- To achieve harmony:
  - ✓The Self's needs must be met with right understanding and relationships.
  - ✓The Body's needs must be met with physical facilities.
- Key Insight: True happiness comes from right understanding, not material possessions.



Image Source: https://brendanfetters.com/

The Body as an Instrument of the Self

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The Role of the Body as an Instrument

- The Body follows instructions given by the Self.
- **Example:** Deciding to write or walk—Self makes the decision, Body executes it.
- A calm and content Self results in a relaxed and healthy Body.
- **Stress** and **anxiety** in the Self negatively affect the Body.

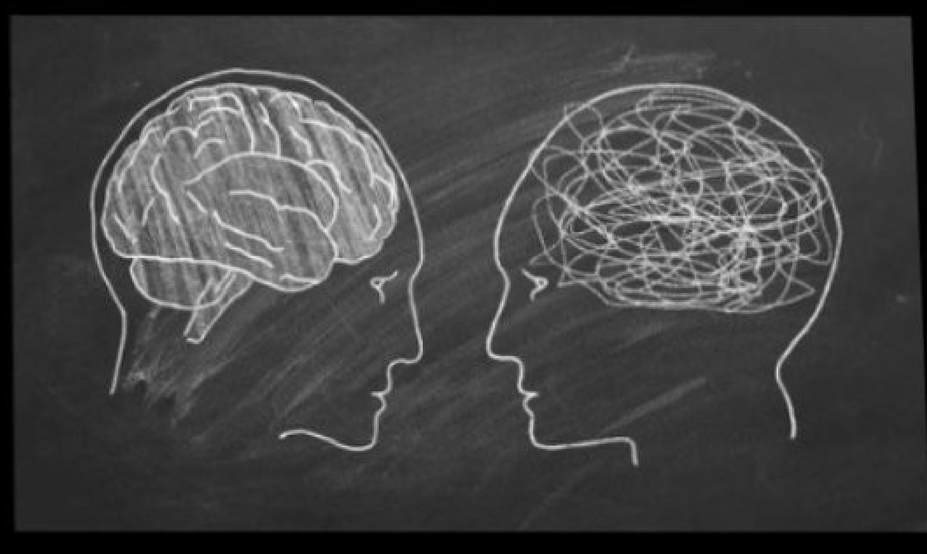


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Continuous Nature of Self Activities

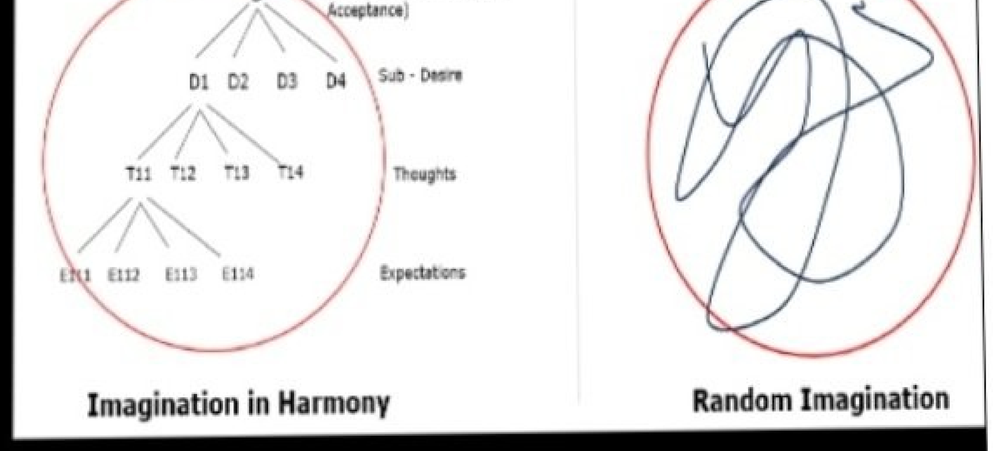
- The activities of the Self never stop.
- The mind continuously engages in desires, thoughts, and expectations.
- Awareness of these activities helps maintain inner harmony.



Image Source: https://www.freepik.com/

Imagination and Its Influence

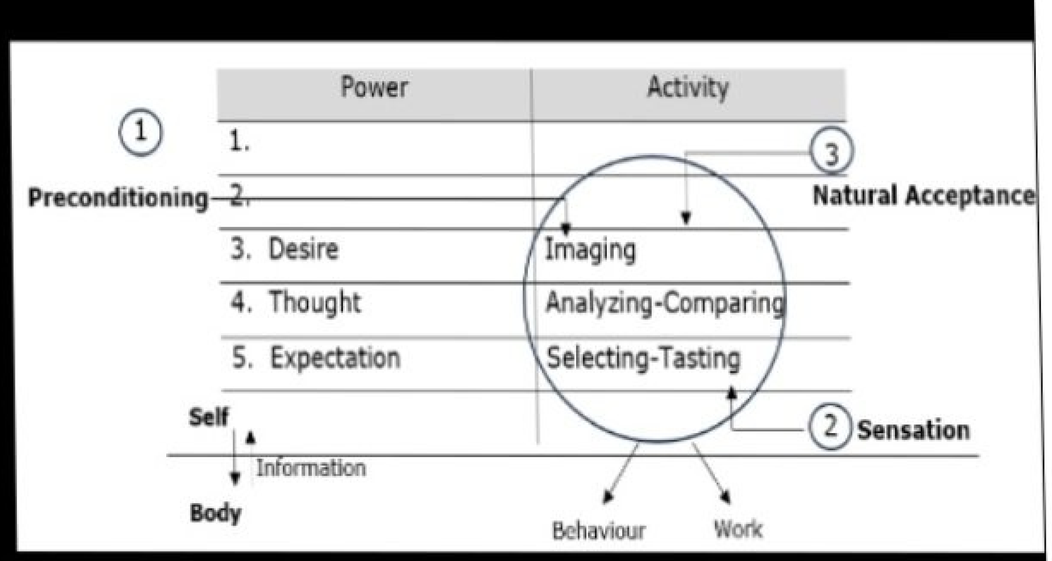
- Imagination consists of desires, thoughts, and expectations.
- It influences behavior and work.
- A positive imagination aligned with natural acceptance results in happiness.
- Negative imagination leads to inner conflict and unhappiness.



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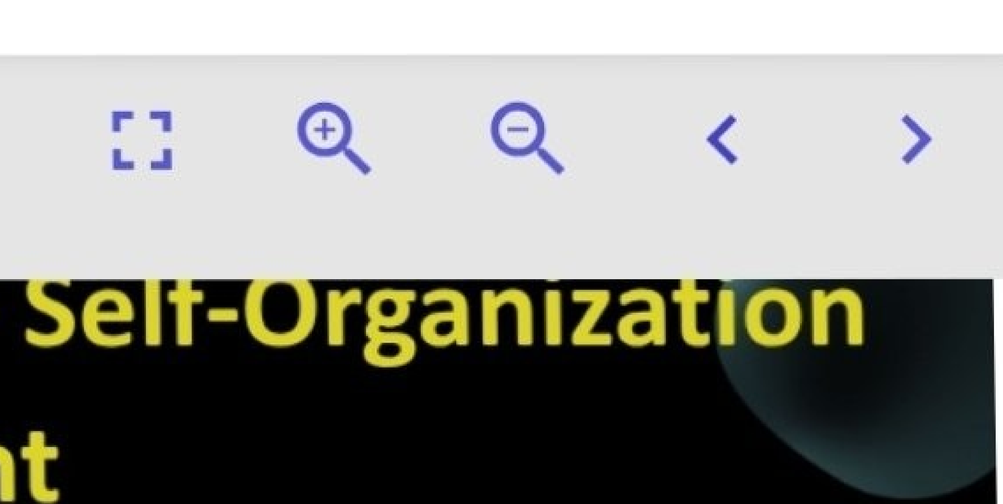
Sources of Imagination

- **Three key sources:**
  - **Preconditioning: Influences from society and upbringing.**
  - **Sensation: Impact of sensory experiences (sight, sound, taste, etc.)**
  - **Natural Acceptance: Internal guidance for long-term well-being.**
- **Identifying these sources helps in self-awareness and conscious decision-making.**



Consequences of Imagination – Self-Organization vs. Enslavement

- **Self-Organization:**
  - ✓ Making choices based on natural acceptance.
  - ✓ Leads to inner harmony, happiness, and responsible living.
- **Enslavement:**
  - ✓ Controlled by preconditioning and sensory cravings.
  - ✓ Results in conflict, dissatisfaction, and lack of control.



Achieving Self-Organization

- Self-organization happens when desires, thoughts, and expectations are aligned with natural acceptance.
- This alignment leads to clarity, inner peace, and better decision-making.
- **Example:** Instead of desiring wealth blindly, we realize that security and respect are the real aspirations.



Image Source: https://easyretro.io/

Role of Sanskar in Achieving Harmony

- Sanskar is our accumulated set of beliefs, experiences, and values.

•Sanskar=∑[Desire(alltime)+Thought(alltime)+ Expectation(alltime)]



- Sanskar keeps updating based on:

✓Environment (t) – External experiences.

✓Self-Exploration (t) – Personal reflection and understanding.

Impact of Sanskar on Happiness

- If our Sanskar is based on right understanding, it leads to harmony and happiness.
- If it is based on wrong assumptions or preconditioning, it causes disharmony.
- **Example:** Mistrust due to social conditioning vs. Trust through self-exploration.



Image Source: https://www.discovermagazine.com/

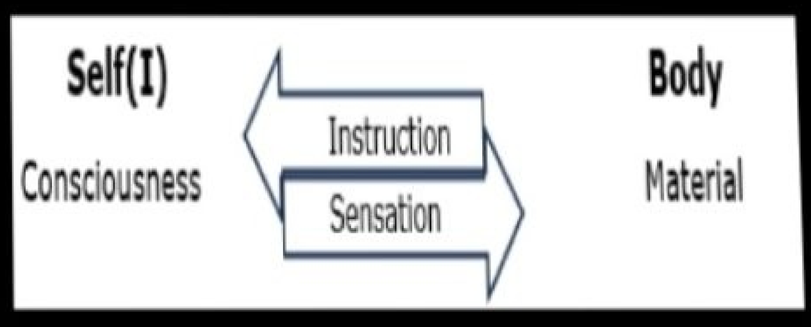
Understanding Harmony in the Self with the Body

Introduction to Harmony of the Self with the Body

- A human being consists of two components:

✓The Self (Consciousness) – Responsible for thinking, feeling, and decision-making.

✓The Body (Material) – Acts as an instrument to carry out physical actions.



- Both must function in harmony to ensure well-being and happiness.

The Self as the Seer, Doer, and Enjoyer

- **Seer:** Observes reality and associates meaning to experiences.
- **Doer:** Makes decisions and directs actions.
- **Enjoyer:** Experiences emotions like happiness, sadness, and joy.

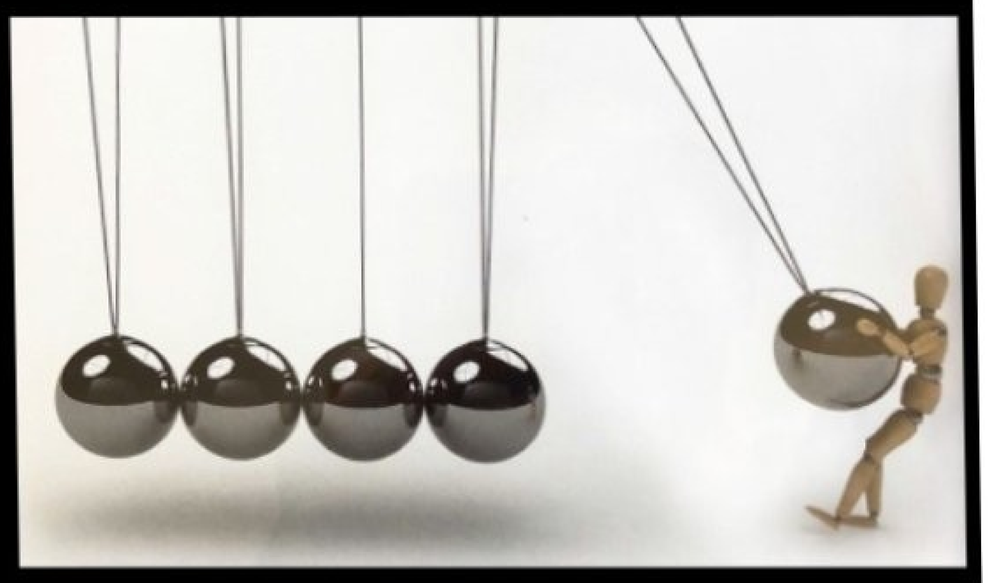


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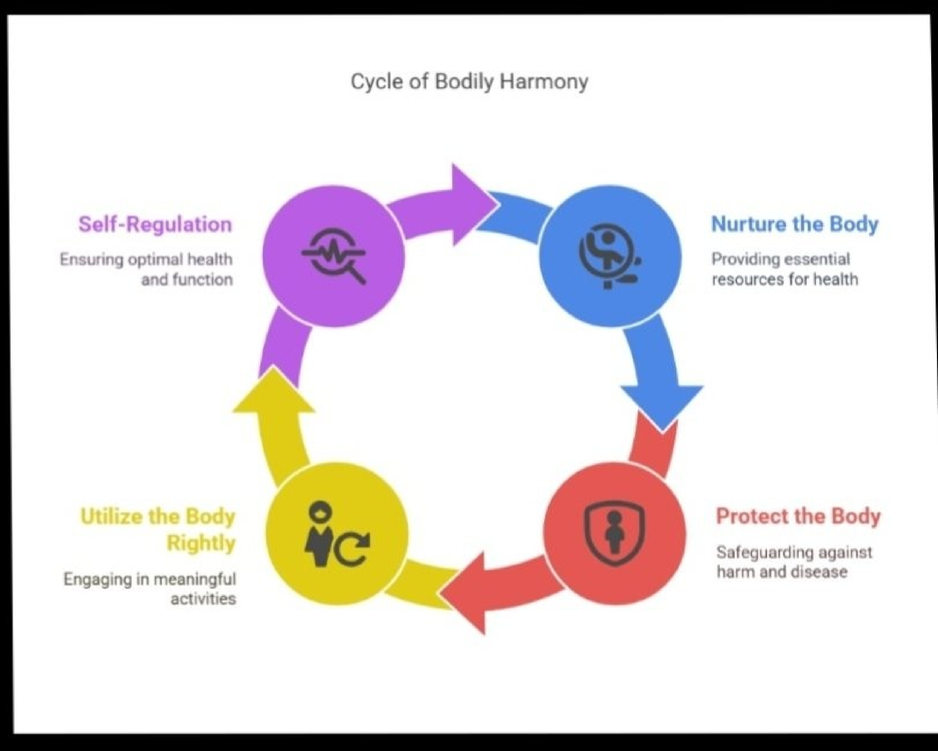
The Body as a Self-Organized System

- The Body functions without conscious effort, maintaining:
  - ✓Interconnectedness – Digestive, respiratory, and nervous systems working together.
  - ✓Self-regulation – Healing minor injuries and maintaining balance.
  - ✓Growth & Development – From a single cell to an adult human.
- The Body supports the Self's aspirations for happiness.



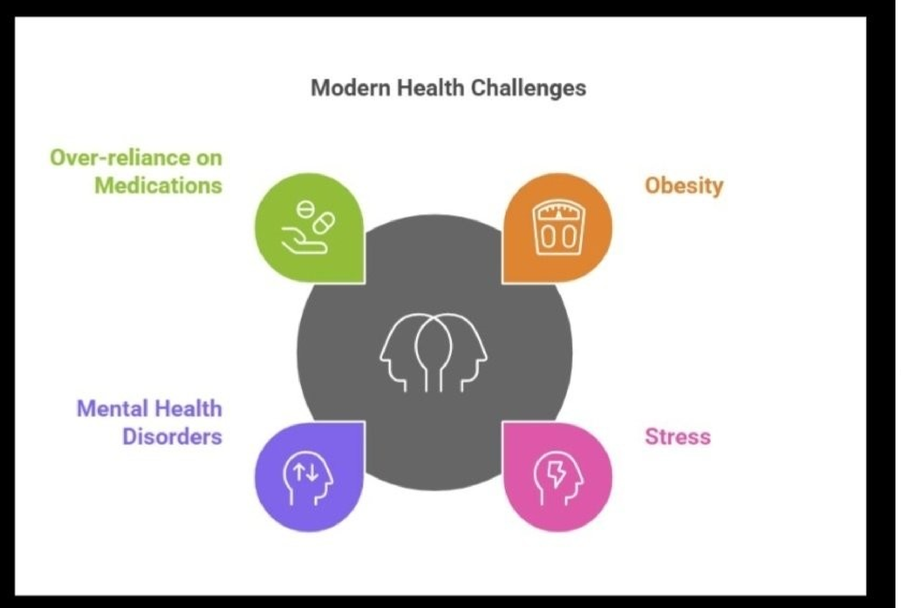
Image Source: https://www.teammeter.com/

- To maintain balance, we must:
  - ✓ Nurture the Body (clean air, water, nutritious food, exercise).
  - ✓ Protect the Body (from injuries, diseases, and harmful environments).
  - ✓ Utilize the Body Rightly (using it for constructive and meaningful activities).
- Self-regulation ensures the Body remains healthy and functions optimally.

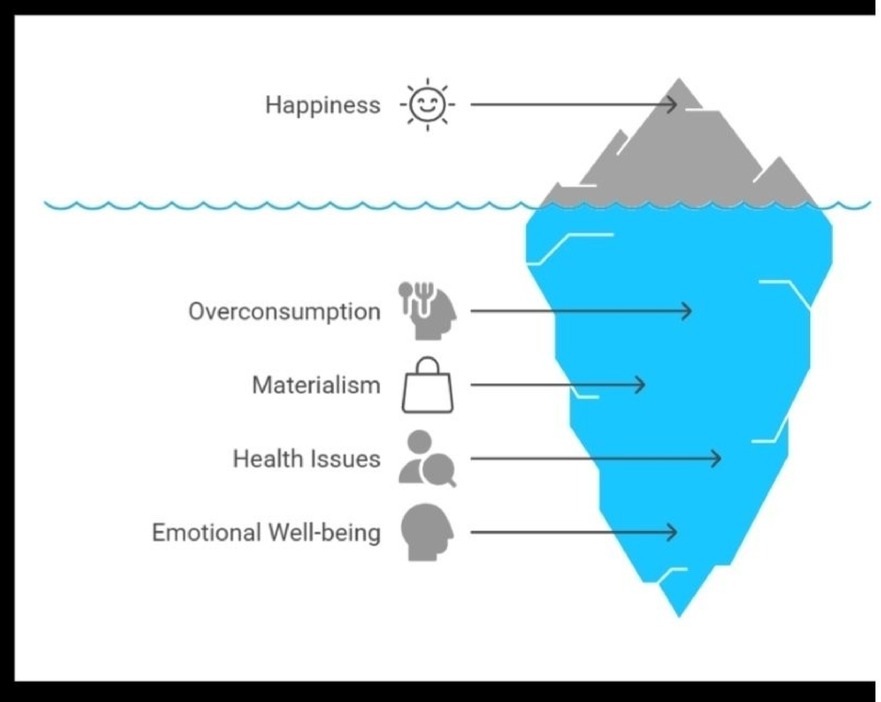


Current Status and Challenges

- **Modern health issues:**
  - ✓ Increasing obesity, stress, and mental health disorders.
  - ✓ Over-reliance on medications instead of preventive care.



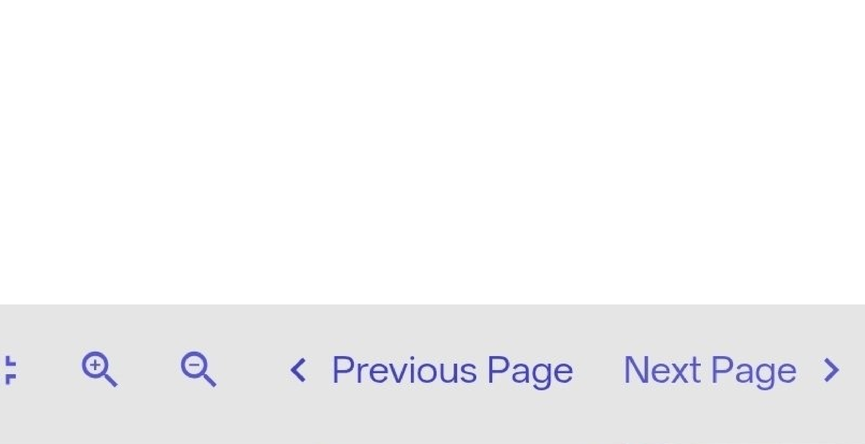
- Misconceptions causing disharmony:
  - ✓Overconsumption of food & luxuries in search of happiness.
  - ✓Materialism – Thinking happiness comes from possessions.
- Many health issues are psycho-somatic:
  - ✓Emotions impact the Body (e.g., stress leading to high blood pressure).
  - ✓The Body impacts the Self (e.g., fatigue




Program to Ensure Self-
Regulation and Health

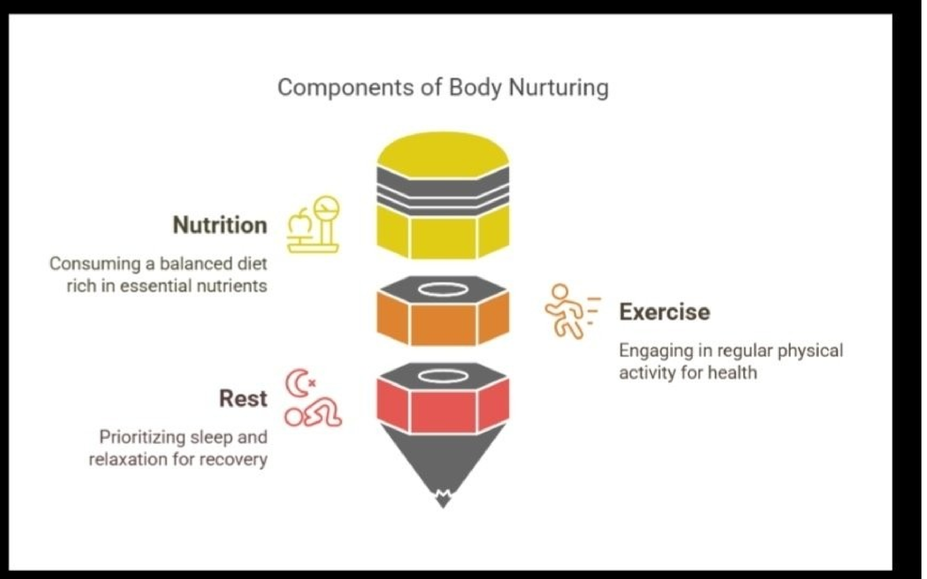
Introduction to Self-Regulation and Health

- A balanced human life requires:
  - ✓Proper nurturing of the Body.
  - ✓Protection from harmful conditions.
  - ✓Right utilization for meaningful purposes.
- Self-regulation ensures a healthy and harmonious life.



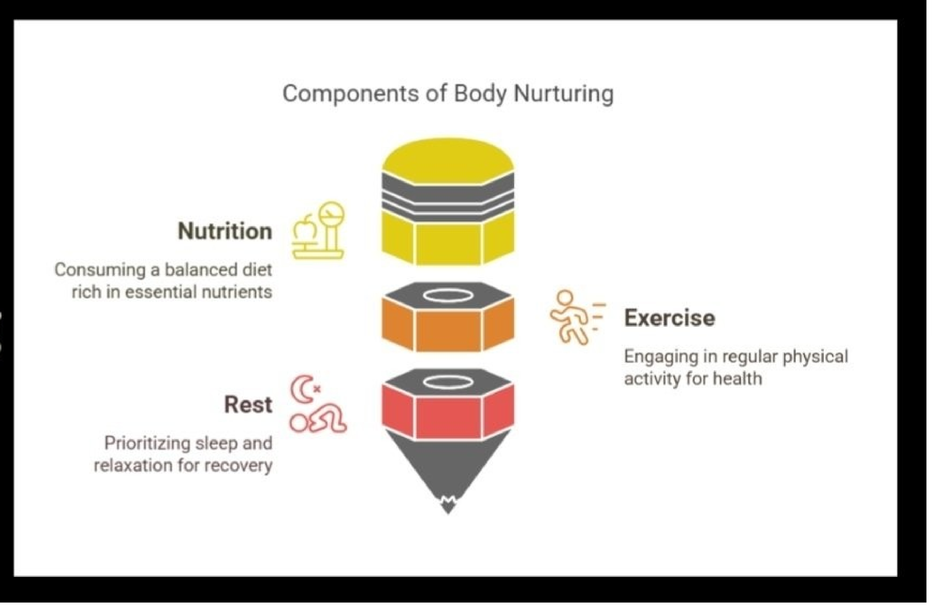
Nurturing the Body

- **Essential inputs for the Body:**
  - ✓ Air, water, food, and sunlight for nourishment.
  - ✓ Routine activities like sleep, hygiene, and meal schedules.
  - ✓ Physical activity – Both labor (productive work) and exercise (fitness



Nurturing the Body

- **Maintaining balance:**
  - ✓ **Proper intake and digestion.**
  - ✓ **Regulating breathing and organ health.**
  - ✓ **Medicine and treatment for restoring balance.**



•Ensuring safety through:

✓Clothing suited to climate conditions.

✓Shelter for comfort and security.

✓Vaccinations to develop immunity.

•Hygiene and safety measures

✓Preventing diseases through cleanliness.

✓Using protective gear during physical activities.

✓Avoiding harmful substances and pollutants.



Image Source: https://www.123rf.com/

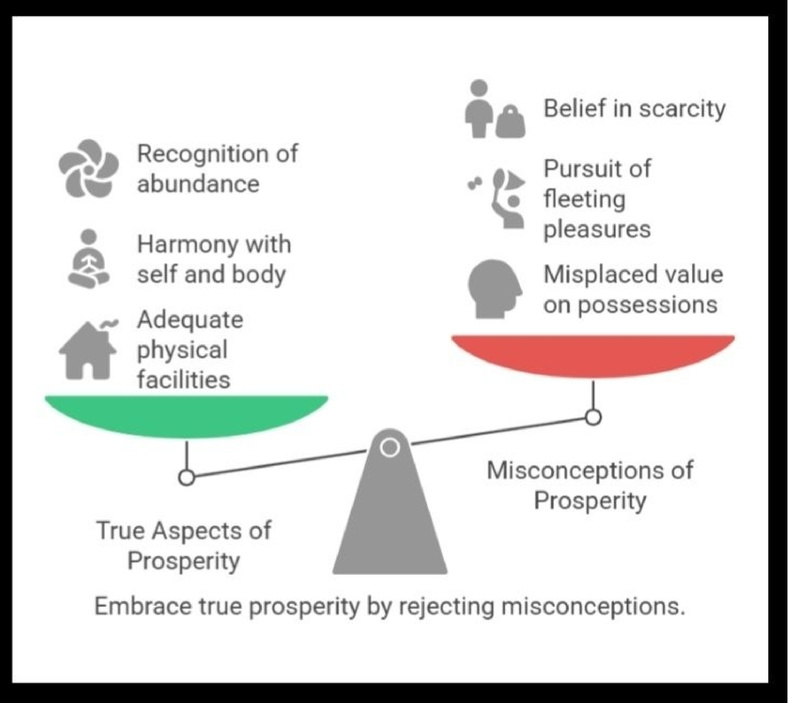
- **The Body should be used purposefully for:**
  - ✓**Right Understanding & Right Feeling – Expressing love, respect, and care.**
  - ✓**Producing and Protecting Physical Facilities – Engaging in meaningful work.**
- **Avoid misuse:**
  - ✓**Not engaging in harmful habits.**
  - ✓**Avoiding overindulgence in sensory pleasures**



Image Source: https://www.linkedin.com/

Revisiting Prosperity in Light of Harmony

- **Prosperity is not unlimited accumulation but:**
  - ✓ **Having more than enough physical facilities.**
  - ✓ **Living in harmony with the Self and the Body.**
- **Misconceptions about Prosperity:**
  - ✓ **Thinking happiness comes from physical possessions.**
  - ✓ **Pursuing sensual pleasures over meaningful living.**



- For the Self:
  - ✓Cultivating right understanding and positive feelings.
  - ✓Aligning imagination with natural acceptance.
- For the Body:
  - ✓Practicing self-regulation and maintaining hygiene.
  - ✓Ensuring adequate nutrition, rest, and physical activity.
- Outcome: A state of happiness, peace, and

